

3.3 Templates

The advantage of working with an office suite is that almost all the tools of the suite have a lot in common. You will find that working with templates is no different in Impress from, say, Writer. Since we've already explained templates in Writer, we'll skip past the basics and get on to a little more advanced template working.

3.3.1 Making Templates

You can create your own templates easily with Impress. All you have to do is format and save a presentation, then go to **File > Templates > Save**, and in the New Template box, type out a name for your template. Select the category which you want to make your template part of and click OK; the template will be saved. It really is that simple; of course, you have to do all the hard work of formatting a presentation or slide, applying formats and styles and setting fonts, colours and backgrounds, all before saving as a template.

3.3.2 Using Templates From Existing Files

Once you've used Impress, you will easily learn how to use the default templates that come with it. However, now that you have created your own templates, how do you apply them to a presentation that you are currently working on, or even a new presentation you're going to create? This even works for installing templates that you have downloaded and installed...

First we'll show you how to install a template using the Extensions Manager. Select **Tools > Extension Manager**, click **Add**, browse to the downloaded templates file, and click **Open**. Now select which template you want available to you and then click **Enable**. This template will now be available to you when working in Impress. The Extensions Manager is common for all OOo tools.

In order to set a custom default template, go to **File > Templates > Organize**, and on the left, browse to the folder that contains your template. Click on the **Commands** button and select "Set As Default Template". If you want to reset the template to OOo's